



» HOCKEY WORLD CUP INDIA REVIEW

REALITY CHECK HERE, A PROMISING STEP THERE

India's men's team leaves the World Cup with **difficult questions** to answer, while the women's side's progress offers reasons for optimism ahead of the Asian Games.

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Even though the World Cup is among the pinnacles of the sport, it's safe to say the timing of this edition was one of major inconvenience for the Indian men's team.

After the year it had endured, in which it had been well short of matching the top contenders, the World Cup only served as a magnifying glass, amplifying the current flaws in the set-up.

Without it, India would have gone into the Asian Games as a hot favourite to retain the gold, which might have masked its

deficiencies.

At the World Cup in Amstelveen, its flaws across all fronts were laid bare. The manner of the capitulation in the must-win game against Argentina would have brought back nightmares of the 8-0 drubbing the South American side dished out in the Pro League earlier